We staked TMC.
Bengal voted otherwise.

DECISION INFRASTRUCTURE · 4 MAY 2026

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Every party landed outside the band.

TMC	BJP	LEFT + CONG	OTHERS
PREDICTED	PREDICTED	PREDICTED	PREDICTED
194 ± 10	45 ± 10	50 ± 10	5 ± 3
ACTUAL	ACTUAL	ACTUAL	ACTUAL
84	**203**	**6**	**1**
-110	+158	-44	-4

BJP voteshare 45.1% (modelled ~22%) · TMC 41.0% (modelled ~52%)

Bengal predicted. Bengal voted.

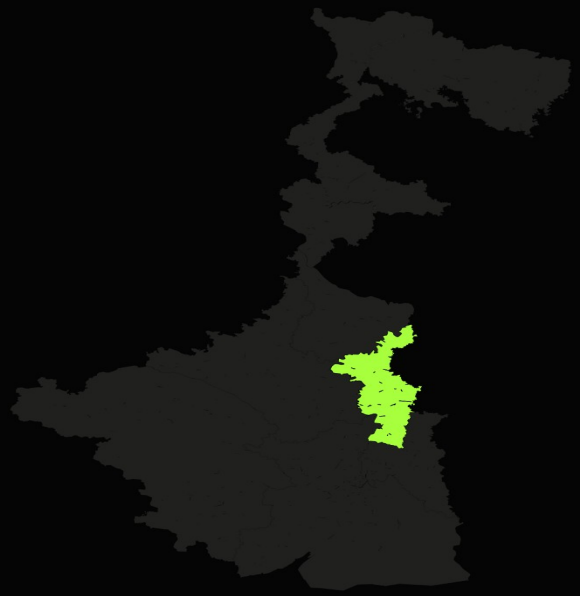
PREDICTED

Predicted: TMC majority across 9 clusters · 194 ± 10 seats

ACTUAL

Actual: TMC held 1 cluster · 84 seats

Matua Belt (Nadia · N24Pgs): TMC → BJP



PREDICTED

TMC 65%

BJP 30%

ACTUAL

TMC 30%

BJP 60%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 28 · BJP 12

Act: BJP 33 · TMC 7

THE FACTOR

Reverse CAA swing.

Matua identification with BJP's CAA delivery, not the modelled backlash.

40 SEATS

Presidency Suburbs: TMC → BJP

PREDICTED

TMC 52%
BJP 30%

ACTUAL

TMC 36%
BJP 50%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 28 · BJP 12
Act: BJP 30 · TMC 10

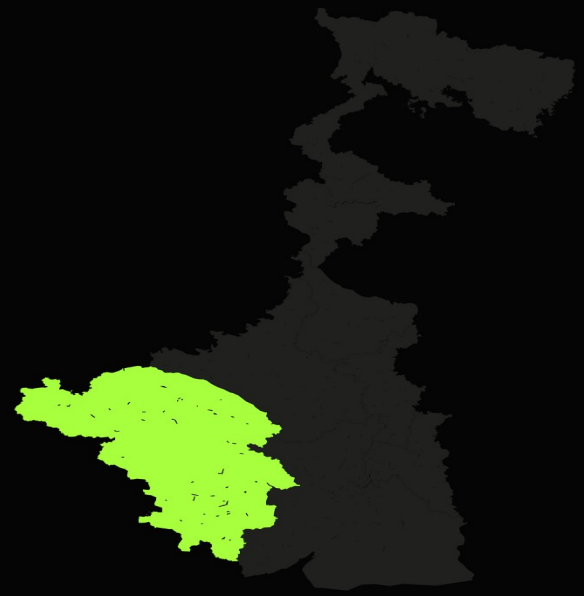
THE FACTOR

Hindu consolidation.

Unified BJP voteshare across heterogeneous suburbs.

40 SEATS

Jungle Mahal: TMC → BJP



PREDICTED

TMC 58%
BJP 28%

ACTUAL

TMC 32%
BJP 56%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 38 · BJP 12

Act: BJP 38 · TMC 12

THE FACTOR

Sustained BJP organisation.

2021 anti-BJP correction did not stick; rural welfare delivery held.

50 SEATS

South Rural: TMC → BJP

PREDICTED

TMC 55%
BJP 32%

ACTUAL

TMC 35%
BJP 52%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 25 · BJP 10

Act: BJP 26 · TMC 9

THE FACTOR

Anti-incumbency.

Corruption cases (Sandeshkhali, recruitment scam) cut deepest here.

35 SEATS

Kolkata Urban: TMC → BJP

PREDICTED

TMC 50%
BJP 28%

ACTUAL

TMC 36%
BJP 48%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 22 · BJP 10
Act: BJP 20 · TMC 12

THE FACTOR

Muslim vote split.

4-way fragmentation handed BJP pluralities in Muslim-mixed seats.

32 SEATS

Burdwan Industrial: TMC → BJP

PREDICTED

TMC 53%

BJP 30%

ACTUAL

TMC 35%

BJP 50%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 17 · BJP 8

Act: BJP 18 · TMC 7

THE FACTOR

Industrial worker swing.

Economic anxiety + Hindu consolidation, not modelled together.

25 SEATS

North Bengal: TMC → BJP

PREDICTED

TMC 48%

BJP 35%

ACTUAL

TMC 28%

BJP 56%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 14 · BJP 10

Act: BJP 22 · TMC 2

THE FACTOR

SIR voter-roll deletions.

Disproportionate impact in Muslim-majority blocks; turnout asymmetry.

24 SEATS

Murshidabad: TMC → TMC

PREDICTED

TMC 78%
BJP 12%

ACTUAL

TMC 52%
BJP 38%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 19 · BJP 3
Act: TMC 13 · BJP 9

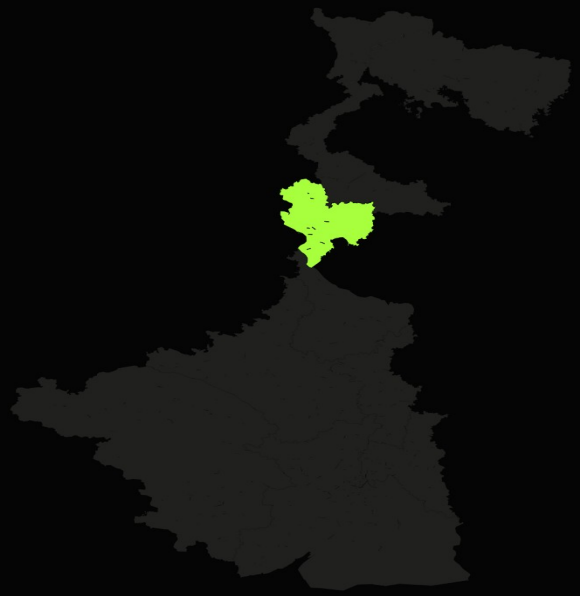
THE FACTOR

Held — but barely.

Muslim consolidation worked here as modelled. The model was right about this cluster.

22 SEATS

Malda: TMC → BJP



PREDICTED

TMC 56%

BJP 30%

ACTUAL

TMC 38%

BJP 48%

SEATS

Pred: TMC 7 · BJP 4 · INC 1

Act: BJP 7 · TMC 4 · INC 1

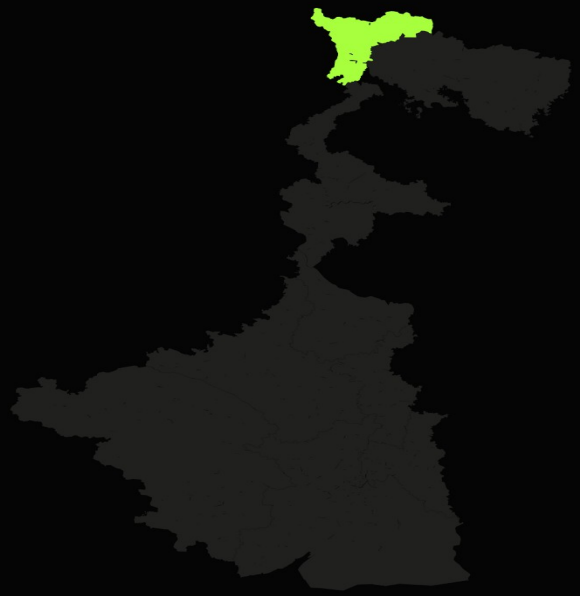
THE FACTOR

Muslim split + INC weakness.

AIMIM/AJUP fragmentation handed BJP pluralities.

12 SEATS

Darjeeling Hills: BJP → BJP



PREDICTED

TMC 22%
BJP 50%

ACTUAL

TMC 20%
BJP 60%

SEATS

Pred: BJP/GJM 10 · TMC 3

Act: BJP/GJM 10 · TMC 2 · Oth 1

THE FACTOR

Correctly predicted.

BJP/GJM alliance worked as modelled.

13 SEATS

Three things to fix in the model.

01 **Anchoring on 2021 baseline.**

Uniform-swing assumed corrections of 10-20pp; realised swing was 25-30pp.

02 **Hindu consolidation modelled as localized.**

The data shows it was the dominant statewide frame.

03 **SIR weight too small.**

Modelled as marginal; reality showed structural turnout asymmetry across all Muslim-majority clusters.

We'll be back

for the next nail-biter.

INDIA · 28 STATES · EVERY ELECTION ITS OWN PHYSICS

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